

L E S S O N 16

Does Baptism Save You? The Truth from Scripture

6: Baptism

Scripture Focus: *Romans 6:3-4 · Ephesians 2:8-9 · Luke 23:43*

The Greek word baptizo means “to immerse” — a symbolic act representing the believer's union with Christ's death, burial, and resurrection. But baptism does not save. Salvation is by grace through faith alone. Baptism is a public testimony of a salvation already received, not a means of earning it.

B Y T H E E N D

You Will...

A	Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.
B	Connect the main truth to Romans 6:3-4 and Ephesians 2:8-9 and Luke 23:43.
C	Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.

V O C A B U L A R Y

Key Terms

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Baptism	The public sign of identification with Christ and His people, pointing to union with Him in death and resurrection.

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Scripture	God's written Word, authoritative and sufficient for knowing Him, understanding salvation, and walking faithfully.
Sin	Any failure to love, trust, worship, and obey God as He deserves; sin separates people from God and requires divine rescue.
Resurrection	Christ's bodily rising from the dead, vindicating His person and securing the believer's hope.
Salvation	God's gracious rescue of sinners through the finished work of Christ, received by faith rather than earned by works.

TEACHING NOTES

I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see Does Baptism Save You? The Truth from Scripture from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. The Greek word baptizo means "to immerse" — a symbolic act representing the believer's union with Christ's death, burial, and resurrection. But baptism does not save. Salvation is by grace through faith alone. Baptism is a public testimony of a salvation already received, not a means of earning it.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

II. What Scripture Says

Romans 6:3-4 and Ephesians 2:8-9 and Luke 23:43 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. So, when John says to Jesus in the passage, "I should really be baptized by you." In other words, "You are the perfect example, the sinless son of God." He's highlighting that baptism does not save, and that he is even not even worthy to baptize Jesus.

Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

III. The Doctrine Explained

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. Baptism is one of the most significant steps a believer takes in the Christian life. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT

Romans 6:3-4

Romans 6:3-4 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read Romans 6:3-4 first, then read Ephesians 2:8-9 and Luke 23:43. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

So, when John says to Jesus in the passage, "I should really be baptized by you." In other words, "You are the perfect example, the sinless son of God." He's highlighting that baptism does not save, and that he is even not even worthy to baptize Jesus.

Study the passage:

1. What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?
2. What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?
3. How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?

FRAMEWORK

Baptism in Proper Order

BIBLICAL ORDER	WHAT TO AVOID
Christ saves by grace through faith.	Treating baptism as the cause of salvation.
Baptism publicly identifies a believer with Christ.	Reducing baptism to a private symbol with no church connection.
Obedience follows faith.	Delaying obedience because every question is not yet answered.

PAUSE & REFLECT

Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does Does Baptism Save You? The Truth from Scripture most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?

IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. Baptism is one of the most significant steps a believer takes in the Christian life. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. In this study, we will explore the meaning, purpose, biblical basis, and some implications of baptism for our lives today. Biblical teaching should train the believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

VI. How This Changes Daily Life

Does Baptism Save You? The Truth from Scripture belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. It's an act of obedience. We see the early church practice this, specifically in Acts chapter 2. Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Does Baptism Save You? The Truth from Scripture should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **In the context of the Christian faith, baptism is a symbolic act that represents a believer's identification with Jesus Christ.**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

REFLECTION

Questions for the Lesson

1. *What should become clearer in your thinking about does baptism save you? the truth from scripture?*

2. *Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*

3. *What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

PUT INTO PRACTICE

A Discipleship Conversation

Imagine a newer believer asks you about does baptism save you? the truth from scripture. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.

Your Task

1. **Use Romans 6:3-4 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.**

2. **Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.**

3. **Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.**
